

Wardstone

Player-facing description

A carved protective stone that marks where safety begins, hums when the ward is healthy, and sounds wrong when the network is failing.

Public role

A carved protective node that projects a local ward and quietly participates in the ward economy

Handout text

Player-safe note: A stone ward-node that protects a place, records crossings, and may skim ambient soul-signal when tied to the corporate network.

GM truth

A wardstone is a carved stone node that projects protection, suppresses monster manifestation and wild-magic bleed, records crossings, and, in the GM-only layer, skims soul-signal when tied to Soulspire Solutions' network.

GM handling

Use when the scene needs a concrete object for players to inspect, carry, debate, or remember.

Mechanics

- Title: Discovery / Earn-It Mechanics
- Player Safe: Players can inspect, handle, keep, trade, reveal, or earn Wardstone when it is present in the fiction.
- Gm Only: Use the roll only when the player's method, stakes, and consequence are concrete.
- No Roll Reveals: Surface read: A stone ward-node that protects a place, records crossings, and may skim ambient soul-signal when tied to the corporate network. Give obvious visible facts freely; roll for meaning, risk, leverage, cost, or a hidden angle.
- Rolls: entity-wardstone-engage-wardstone entity-wardstone Engage Wardstone Engage Wardstone Knowledge Finesse Instinct Presence Knowledge Finesse, Instinct, Presence 12 Choose the trait from the player's method, not the entity type. A flat read of Wardstone hides the cost, motive, or useful next step. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives

a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. A flat...

- Fear Spends: Reveal who benefits from the current situation. Make the cost personal without closing off player agency.
- Condition Options: No official condition unless the item or clue physically creates Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable
- Search Loot: A chipped wardstone fragment is dangerous evidence: useful for study, risky near spellcasting, and valuable enough to invite custody claims.

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